

MD Studio quick reference

Getting started

- **New document**, **Open file...**, or pick a file from **Recent** on the start screen. You can also drop .md files anywhere on the window; each opens in its own tab.
- Click **MD Studio** in the toolbar to return to the start screen.
- In Edge and Chrome, a recent file marked **File on disk** reopens the file itself, with its current content, and Save writes back to it. The browser may ask once to allow access. **Saved copy** entries (other browsers, or files that moved) open the copy MD Studio kept.
- Your open document is saved in the browser automatically. Close the tab and it is still there next time.
- **Try the sample document** opens a short tour of MD Studio and Markdown as a new, unsaved document.
- The ✕ next to a recent file removes it from the list, and **Clear list** empties it. The files themselves are not touched.
- The links under the start screen open this guide (in a tab, or as a PDF), the book *Writing in Plain Text* (PDF or EPUB) and the project dashboard. The guide opens as a document in its own tab, so you can search it. Both the guide and the book are downloaded with the app and open offline.

Views

View	What you see
Split	Markdown source on the left, the formatted document on the right
Text	Markdown source only
Visual	Formatted document only

Both panes edit the same document. Type in either one and the other updates a moment later.

Linked scroll (split view) keeps both panes on the same section as you scroll. Turn it off in the toolbar or in Settings.

Front matter, the YAML metadata block some tools put at the top of a file between two - - - lines, shows in the visual view as a grey box labelled Front matter. As in Pandoc, a . . . line may close it instead, and a - - - followed by a blank line is a rule, not front matter. Edit it there as plain text; Backspace in an empty box removes it.

Formatting

In the visual view, the toolbar above the document formats without keyboard shortcuts: text style (paragraph or heading 1 to 4), bold, italic, strikethrough, inline code, link, bulleted and numbered lists, quote, code block, table and horizontal rule. Buttons show as pressed when the selection

already has that formatting. A link asks for its address; clearing the address removes the link.

Images

Paste an image (Ctrl+V) or drop an image file into either pane.

In Edge and Chrome, once the document is saved on disk, MD Studio asks you the first time to pick the folder the document is in. Images then go into an `images` folder next to the document and are linked from it. The Markdown stays small, and the images travel with the folder (and with git). Choose *Cancel* to embed the image instead.

In other browsers, or before the document is saved, the image is shrunk to at most 1600 px and embedded in the document itself.

Finding and navigating

- **Find** (Ctrl+F) and **Find and replace** (Ctrl+H) open a bar above the editors. It searches the pane you are working in: the Markdown source, or the formatted document in visual view. Options: match case (Aa), whole word (W) and regular expressions (.*). Enter goes to the next match, Shift+Enter to the previous one, Escape closes the bar. A replacement in either pane appears in the other.
- **Outline** (toolbar, or Ctrl+Shift+O) lists the document's headings. Click one to bring that section to the top of both panes; the section you are reading is highlighted.
- In the command palette (Ctrl+K), type # to list the headings instead of commands, then a few letters to narrow them down and Enter to jump. *Go to heading...* in the palette does the same.

Settings

Ctrl+, or **Settings** in the toolbar. Besides theme, default view and linked scroll:

- **Text size** (small, medium, large) for both panes.
- **Wrap long lines** and **Show line numbers** for the Markdown pane.
- **Load web images** is off by default. A web image (`https://...`) tells its server that, and when, the document was opened, so until you turn this on the visual pane shows its description in a dashed frame instead. Pasted images and images next to the file always show.
- **Help and reading** at the bottom opens this guide and the book from anywhere in the app. The command palette has them too: *Open the user guide*, *Open the user guide (PDF)*, *Open the book* and *Download the book (EPUB)*.

The Export dialog remembers the format and theme you used last.

Tabs

- **New**, **Open**, a **Recent** file or a dropped file each open in a new tab. An empty, untouched new document is reused instead of piling up.
- Opening a file that is already open switches to its tab. Without a link to the file on disk (other

browsers, dropped files) MD Studio goes by the name and the content it was opened with.

- The tab bar appears once two documents are open. Click a tab to switch; the arrow keys move between tabs when one has focus. Each tab keeps its cursor and scroll position.
- Drag a tab to reorder, or press Shift+<- / Shift+> on a focused tab.
- Two tabs with the same file name show the document's first heading, for example *notes.md · Plan*.
- ✕ or a middle click closes a tab. A tab with unsaved changes asks first. Closing the last tab returns to the start screen.
- All open tabs, saved or not, are still there after closing and reopening the app.

Saving

- **Save** (Ctrl+S) writes back to the file you opened in Edge or Chrome, even after closing and reopening the app (the browser may ask once to allow access again). The first save of a new document asks where to put it.
- **Save as...** (Ctrl+Shift+S) always asks.
- In Firefox, Safari and on phones, Save downloads the file instead.
- A dot next to the file name means there are unsaved changes.
- A file is saved the way it was written: same line endings and the same encoding (UTF-8, UTF-16, or Windows-1252 for older Windows files). If you add a character that encoding can't hold, the file is saved as UTF-8 instead and MD Studio tells you.
- If the file changed on disk (another app, another device syncing the folder), MD Studio notices when you come back to the window: a tab without unsaved changes reloads, and Save asks before overwriting the newer version.

Exporting

Export (toolbar, or *Export...* in the command palette) saves a copy of the document in another format. Your Markdown file stays as it is, and stays the file that Save writes to.

Format	What you get
Web page (HTML)	A standalone page styled like the visual view, light, dark, or matching the reader's system theme
PDF	An A4 document for sharing and printing
Word document (DOCX)	Editable in Word, with real headings, lists, tables and links
Plain text	Formatting marks removed, structure kept

Pasted images and images in the document's `images` folder come along (PDF: PNG and JPEG; Word also GIF); images on the web are not fetched and show their alt text. Footnotes become numbered notes at the end.

Front matter is left out of exports and print. To include it, as a code block at the top, tick **Include front matter in exports and print** in the Export dialog or in Settings.

The command palette also has a direct command per format, e.g. *Export as PDF*. PDF uses standard fonts: Latin text (including æ, ø, å) comes through, but emoji and non-Latin scripts are left out. The first PDF or Word export needs a connection; after that they work offline too.

Installing

In Edge or Chrome, use **Install app** in the address bar. On Windows, the installed app can open .md files: right-click a file -> *Open with* -> MD Studio. On a phone, use *Add to Home Screen*; open documents from inside the app.

Keyboard shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+K or Ctrl+Shift+P	Command palette
Ctrl+S / Ctrl+Shift+S	Save / Save as
Ctrl+O	Open file
Alt+N	New document
Alt+W	Close tab
Alt+PageDown / Alt+PageUp	Next / previous tab
Ctrl+1 / Ctrl+2 / Ctrl+3	Split / Text / Visual view
Ctrl+F / Ctrl+H	Find / Find and replace
Ctrl+Shift+O	Show or hide the outline
Ctrl+,	Settings
Ctrl+B / Ctrl+I	Bold / italic (visual pane)
Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y	Undo / redo (in the focused pane)

On macOS use Cmd in place of Ctrl. Ctrl+1, Ctrl+2 and Ctrl+3 work in the installed app; in a normal browser tab they switch browser tabs instead, so use the toolbar or the command palette there. Ctrl+W and Ctrl+Tab always belong to the browser, which is why closing and switching MD Studio tabs uses Alt.